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The case for Mintlify

Today, every prospect meets a person before they meet the product. This paper makes the case for changing that.

The problem

Manual, Back Office and Sales-led enablement for every proof of value.

The proposal

Adopt Mintlify as a self-service distribution site, in the model of PLAID.

The ask

Approve an investigation spike before formal contracting.

SCENE SETTING

Where enablement happens today

Every prospect and customer question currently routes through a person, with no self-service path.

WHAT WE HAVE

- Intercom Help Center for in-product articles
- LearnWorlds Academy for structured courses
- Sales walks every prospect through a live demo
- Support and Customer Success run manual POV setup

WHY IT DOESN'T SCALE

- No sandbox — every evaluation needs a booked call
- Contracting conversations start before value is proven
- Back Office time is spent on repeat manual walkthroughs
- Sales cycle length is tied to internal calendar availability

TARGET STATE

Prospects arrive warm, not cold

The goal: a visitor tries Omnisient on sample data, sees the value, and only then starts a commercial conversation.

1 Try before they buy

Self-service access to a working sample of the platform, no meeting required.

2 Warm, not cold

Sales engages once a prospect has already seen value on their own time.

3 Contracting comes last

Commercial conversations start after proof, not instead of it.

⚑ **US strategy already names the target: a self-service distribution site, in the model of PLAID.**

REQUIREMENTS

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What we need from a tool

The right platform needs to do six things well, from public docs to CRM hand-off.

Public + protected docs

Free-to-browse pages, gated content behind login.

Self-service sandbox path

A working example a prospect can try alone.

Agent-readable access

The same content works for a human and for Claude Code.

Docs-as-code workflow

Git-backed authoring, previews, and review.

Region-aware delivery

Right content for the right market, one source.

Sales & CRM hand-off

Curated milestones flow to Salesforce, not raw data.

COMPETITOR COMPARISON

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Mintlify vs. Intercom, and the rest of the field

Intercom is the incumbent for support. It was never built as a self-service front door.

MINTLIFY — PROPOSED	INTERCOM — RETAINED, NARROWED
✓ Public + protected docs, sandbox-ready	✗ Built for support, not self-service onboarding
✓ Authenticated MCP for AI agent access	✗ Priced per seat, plus $0.99 per Fin AI resolution
✓ Flat platform fee, unlimited seats	✗ No sandbox or developer-portal capability

Also in the field: GitBook (best all-round alternative), ReadMe (API telemetry), Redocly/Scalar (API-design-first), Docusaurus (free, self-hosted). None matched Mintlify's combined score in the earlier platform review.

DEEP DIVE

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Mintlify: cost, contracting, and trust

License cost

Pro: $450/mo (~R7,320), unlimited seats. Enterprise (adds SSO/SCIM/RBAC): custom quote required.

Contracting approach

Pro is self-serve, card-based. Enterprise is sales-led with a custom agreement.

Trial availability

Starter tier is free indefinitely — usable now for an internal spike. No dedicated Enterprise trial.

Application across the business

One platform for public docs, protected developer content, and the self-service sandbox front door.

ZAR / USD

Pro ≈ R7,320/mo at the Aug 2026 average rate (R16.26/USD). Enterprise pricing not yet known.

Vanta listing

Not listed on Vanta. Mintlify's trust center runs on SafeBase/Drata (security.mintlify.com) — InfoSec review routes there instead.

! **Mintlify disclosed and remediated a security incident earlier in 2026 — InfoSec should review the postmortem before sign-off.**

CONCLUSION

Recommendation and next steps

Mintlify is the strongest fit for a self-service front door, at a fraction of what a custom build would cost.

Build vs. buy

A custom sandbox and docs portal would cost engineering months Mintlify replaces for $450/mo.

Proven at scale

Anthropic's Claude docs and Lovable both run on Mintlify today — real, verifiable customers, not a reference call.

The ask

Investigation spike

Sign-off

CTO · CPO · InfoSec

⚑ **Recommended: approve a scoped investigation spike into Mintlify before any formal contracting.**